

ATPL EASA STUDY GUIDE | 010 - AIR LAW

Chapter 13: Airspace Classes (A to G)

Syllabus Source: CAE Oxford (pp. 263-278) | Pass Target: >= 90% AviationExam

1. MASTER AIRSPACE CLASSIFICATION TABLE (ICAO & SERA)

Airspace is categorized into 7 classes (A to G). Classes A to E are Controlled Airspace; Classes F and G are Uncontrolled Airspace. Separation and communications requirements vary strictly by class:

Class	Flights	Separation Provided	Radio Comms	ATC Clearance & Key Rules
Class A	IFR only	IFR from IFR	Continuous 2-way	ATC Clearance MANDATORY. VFR is STRICTLY PROHIBITED.
Class B	IFR & VFR	All flights from all flights	Continuous 2-way	ATC Clearance MANDATORY. Full separation provided to all.
Class C	IFR & VFR	IFR from IFR & VFR. VFR from IFR only.	Continuous 2-way	ATC Clearance MANDATORY. VFR receives traffic info on other VFR.
Class D	IFR & VFR	IFR from IFR only.	Continuous 2-way	ATC Clearance MANDATORY. Traffic information given to VFR on all flights.
Class E	IFR & VFR	IFR from IFR only.	Continuous 2-way for IFR only	Clearance MANDATORY for IFR. VFR does NOT need clearance or radio!
Class F	IFR & VFR	None (Advisory only)	Continuous for participating IFR	Uncontrolled. IFR receives air traffic advisory service.
Class G	IFR & VFR	None	Continuous for IFR where required	Uncontrolled. Flight Information Service (FIS) on request.

[!] EXAM TRAP (AVIATIONEXAM) - Class E Airspace: The Famous AviationExam Trap
Question: Is an ATC clearance required to fly VFR in Class E airspace? Answer: NO. In Class E, VFR flights do NOT require an ATC clearance and do NOT require two-way radio comms. Only IFR flights require ATC clearance and continuous communication in Class E.

2. SPEED LIMITATIONS IN AIRSPACE

- General Speed Limit: A maximum speed of 250 kt IAS applies to all flights operating below FL 100 (or 10,000 ft AMSL), EXCEPT in Class A and B airspace, or when authorized by ATC.

3. SPECIAL USE AIRSPACE

- Prohibited Area (P): Airspace within which flight of aircraft is strictly prohibited.
- Restricted Area (R): Flight of aircraft is restricted in accordance with specified conditions.
- Danger Area (D): Activities dangerous to flight may exist at specified times. Flight is not legally barred, but caution required.

- Temporary Segregated Area (TSA): Airspace temporarily segregated for exclusive use of specific users.
- Temporary Reserved Area (TRA): Airspace temporarily reserved for specific operations with civil transit permitted under ATC.

4. AVIATIONEXAM PRACTICE QUESTIONS (WITH EXPLANATIONS)

Q1: In which airspace classes are VFR flights strictly prohibited?

- [A]: Class A only
- [B]: Classes A and B
- [C]: Classes A, B, and C
- [D]: Class G

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [A]. Class A airspace is reserved exclusively for IFR flights; VFR is prohibited.

Q2: In Class C airspace, does ATC separate VFR flights from other VFR flights?

- [A]: Yes, full separation is provided.
- [B]: No, VFR receives only traffic information in respect of other VFR flights.
- [C]: Only during night operations.
- [D]: Only above FL 100.

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [B]. In Class C, IFR is separated from IFR and VFR. VFR is separated from IFR, but receives only traffic information regarding other VFR.

Q3: Does a VFR flight require an ATC clearance to enter Class E airspace?

- [A]: Yes, clearance is mandatory for all flights.
- [B]: No, VFR flights do not require ATC clearance in Class E.
- [C]: Yes, unless squawking 7000.
- [D]: Only when entering a control zone.

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [B]. Class E is controlled for IFR only. VFR flights do not require ATC clearance or two-way radio communication.

Q4: What is the standard speed limitation for aircraft operating below FL 100 in Class D airspace?

- [A]: 200 kt IAS
- [B]: 250 kt IAS
- [C]: 280 kt IAS
- [D]: No speed limit applies

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [B]. 250 kt IAS is the standard maximum speed below FL 100 across classes C to G.

Q5: What is the definition of a Danger Area (D)?

- [A]: Airspace where flight of aircraft is completely prohibited
- [B]: Airspace within which activities dangerous to the flight of aircraft may exist at specified times
- [C]: Airspace reserved exclusively for supersonic military flight
- [D]: Airspace surrounding a nuclear power plant

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [B]. A Danger Area denotes airspace within which activities dangerous to flight may occur at specified times (flight is not legally barred, unlike a Prohibited area).